

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE COALITION EDITION

The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War

The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 5 OF SIX

The Witnesses Disagreed About the Jacket

Character stories, dialogue and consequential choices

Forty real games. One coalition. Aiden has already overspent.

Fictional wars, adult coalition comedy, reclaimed in-group language and innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan’s creative direction. The 1967 war is invented history.

Coalition Edition 3.0 - 20 September 2026

240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; the coalition summit and Aiden's rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden’s scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

The long conversation: [The Dance Was Not a Reward for Being Useful](#) - page 27. Desire, femmes and the work of care.

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AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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A route that knows when to shut up

The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 5. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department’s forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

Mood / emblem	1. Envelope	2. Key	3. Plant	4. Map	5. Teacup	6. Spare chair	7. Gold stamp	8. Clock
1. Quietly curious	P161	P162	P163	P164	P165	P166	P167	P168
2. Ready for conversation	P169	P170	P171	P172	P173	P174	P175	P176
3. Willing to inspect a thing	P177	P178	P179	P180	P181	P182	P183	P184
4. Here for the atmosphere	P185	P186	P187	P188	P189	P190	P191	P192
5. Open to a wildcard	P193	P194	P195	P196	P197	P198	P199	P200

Local position = 8 × (row - 1) + emblem. Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case = 40 × (department - 1) + local position.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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My Summit Had Two Eyewitnesses and Neither Endorsed Me

By the time we reached the final wording, the casino convention floor contained a working signing table, an actual clear aisle and a portrait of me big enough to possess its own weather. Nigga, peace had acquired infrastructure.

Mika stood beneath the portrait with a tape measure. They said it might have to leave through the loading entrance. I said that was no way to treat the face of reconciliation.

'It's the width of reconciliation,' Mika replied.

Shawna touched my arm. 'Baby, stop negotiating with the tape.'

At the good table, Rae had put a small wedge under the troublesome leg. Nia watched her check it, put the tools away and return to the draft. My wife caught me watching Nia watch Rae.

'Leave it alone,' she whispered. 'I was observing a promising alliance.' 'They can flirt without a ribbon cutting.'

Across the room sat the women whose memories had helped turn my game night into The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War. Auntie June, eighty-two, retired bus driver and proud butch, had commandeered the chair with the best view of the music. Odessa, known as Dez, eighty-four, retired seamstress and equally proud stud, sat beside her holding the disputed jacket.

They agreed the trouble began at the Blue Comet Social Club in 1967. They disagreed about the song, the weather, the jacket's destination and whether June had ever said she was sorry.

'I said it was unfortunate,' June told Nia.

'That the jukebox broke,' Dez said. 'You didn't mean my coat.'

I offered to appoint a historical commission. June looked at me. 'You got biscuits?'

Rosa brought biscuits before I could explain the commission's mandate. Tank followed with tea. My brother had identified which contribution would receive the more favourable account.

The original peace agreement was supposedly unsigned. June said someone lost the pen. Dez said the pen went home in June's pocket. June said a good crossword was not going to complete itself.

Nia asked what they wanted settled tonight. Dez could return June's jacket, then borrow it again by asking. Everybody could choose a jukebox song. The old stories did not have to become identical.

'And nobody makes me play something because they bought it,' Dez added.

'That sentence belongs in there,' Rae said.

I looked toward the portrait. Its expression suggested generosity without limits. Its invoice suggested limits should have arrived considerably earlier.

Velvet Payroll crossed the floor in half her costume, carrying the other half like an expensive weather event. She wanted her show time confirmed. Remy, currently becoming King Receipts,

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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wanted the working microphone and a place for the ridiculous fanfare he had defended through four separate departments.

Kit, a white butch with excellent opinions about her own entrance, wanted to sing under the light she had chosen. Mercedes wanted her arrangement heard. Porsche wanted one photograph everybody actually agreed to stand in. None of these wishes required another summit about what sort of person had permission to want them.

Nia put her name beside both caucuses she belonged to and carried on correcting the last sentence. Rae passed her a cup. The room survived this overlap without installing a second Nia.

I said I was delighted by the complexity of our coalition.

'Nigga, drink your tea,' Velvet told me.

Rae asked Nia whether the pen always made her writing look like that. Nia admitted the pen was innocent. Rae turned the draft sideways, smiling. 'I can learn it.'

Something quiet happened between them. Not mysterious. Two adults taking pleasure in the particular person across the table.

I almost called the photographer.

Shawna closed my hand around my cup instead. 'You can witness something without owning the picture.'

June asked Dez which song she intended to choose. Dez said it would be a surprise. June declared surprises responsible for at least half the original war.

Mika dimmed the portrait's lamp to improve the table light. My enormous forehead disappeared from the ceiling. The actual people became easier to see.

I sat beside my wife, accepted a biscuit and opened the next story.

The room had enough narrators. For a little while, I intended to hear some of them.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P161 / A PLACE TO START

Coffee Talk

Edition considered: PC first game

Listen to customers in a late-night café, where preparing a drink creates space for intimate conversations and gradually unfolding personal stories.

What you do. Read conversations, prepare requested drinks and follow the people who return to the counter with different concerns.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Choose Main Story with manual text advance; timed Challenge Mode is a different experience, and ingredient selection still needs attention.

Why it might click. Coffee Talk makes a café counter into a place to get to know recurring people. The fantasy setting puts a fresh surface on work, romance, identity, and belonging. Serving drinks influences story branches; the appeal is noticing a person's request and watching relationships develop.

The full catch. Use the main story with manual text advance; avoid timed Challenge mode. Expect substantial reading and ingredient selection. Drink choices can change story branches. Check the brewing interface and text controls; any decorative latte work is a separate hold/drag question.

Try this first. Choose the main Story mode and manual text advance. Serve one early request, then stay for the conversation it supports. Notice whether ingredients add pleasure or interrupt listening; check the exact edition's controls before settling in.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P161 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Coffee Talk

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Barista Declined My Peace Prize

Coffee Talk put a late-night café on the screen. I put six empty cups in front of Rae and announced that refreshments would heal the remaining divisions.

'Where's the coffee?' she asked. 'Arriving as a concept.' 'Nigga, I repair bikes. I know when a thing has no fuel.'

Nia brought her a real cup. No speech. Just remembered how Rae had ordered it earlier, which struck me as suspiciously effective diplomacy.

I offered to name their emerging relationship after the summit. Nia kept looking at Rae. 'Would you like to sit beside me?'

Rae moved her chair. I was still holding the cups. Tank took two and used them to collect the crackers falling through my decorative snack basket.

The café customers had their own reasons for talking. So did the women beside me. Rae wanted to hear about Nia's ridiculous first job; Nia wanted a second coffee to last longer than the first.

I supplied both drinks. Shawna kissed my cheek. Finally, a service contract with benefits.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the café for its conversations if the drink selection feels comfortable. My contribution to romance improved considerably after I stopped trying to put my name on it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Steam supports the first game's premise and drink-driven story. The identified secondary walkthrough separates the main story from timed Challenge objectives; this is a mode-specific recommendation. Manual advance, brewing and hold comfort still need checking in the chosen edition. The whole-game pace field remains unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/914800/>

Source 2: <https://www.trueachievements.com/game/Coffee-Talk/walkthrough>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P162 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Coffee Talk Episode 2: Hibiscus & Butterfly

Edition considered: PC sequel

Return to familiar café company for new conversations and drink-making, with another set of relationships to follow across the nights together.

What you do. Prepare drinks, follow customer conversations and explore the latte-art interface if its particular form of interaction interests you.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Returning relationships and recipes add tracking; fluid latte-art controls may require drawing, dragging or sustained pointer movement.

Why it might click. The second Coffee Talk offers more café conversations with returning and new fantasy customers, additional drink ingredients, and latte-art play. It suits an appetite for spending more time with this particular world rather than racing through a chain of dramatic reveals.

The full catch. Recipes and returning relationships can increase the things to remember. The official description includes fluid-simulation latte art, so drawing or held-pointer demands need checking separately. Nothing about the calm presentation establishes a complete absence of fiddly inputs.

Try this first. Make an early drink and follow one customer's situation. Try the art interface only if it interests you; inspect how to proceed if it does not. Decide whether the return feels welcoming or depends too much on previous familiarity.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P162 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Coffee Talk Episode 2: Hibiscus & Butterfly

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Butterfly Had a Catering Budget

The returning café in Hibiscus & Butterfly made Mika propose a signature drink for the summit. I approved before asking what signature meant. An expensive habit, beautifully consistent. Velvet Payroll wanted a butterfly in the foam. Rae wanted coffee that still tasted like coffee. Nia drew something on a napkin to explain a compromise.

'That's a butterfly?' I asked. 'That's my name,' Nia said. 'You asked me to sign the sample order.'

Kit found her reading glasses on top of the sugar and examined the napkin. 'I can confirm several intentions. None of them are letters.'

Rae laughed, then folded the napkin into her pocket. Nia watched it disappear with the pleased surprise of somebody whose bad handwriting had finally secured a useful outcome.

I asked whether we could enlarge it above the stage. Velvet slid the printing quote back toward me. 'Nigga, let one small thing be small.'

The drinks arrived without edible portraits. Everybody finished theirs. My proposed foam monument remained entirely theoretical.

Aiden's verdict. Return for more café relationships if recipes and text remain inviting. The summit's butterfly may be optional; my face in anyone's drink is now expressly unwanted.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC sequel. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1663220/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P163 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

VA-11 Hall-A: Cyberpunk Bartender Action

Edition considered: PC release

Work behind a cyberpunk bar where mixing drinks gives you time with distinctive customers, their problems and the life outside the counter.

What you do. Read customer exchanges, follow drink recipes and serve mixtures while learning more about the people who visit the bar.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Reading, recipes and customer preferences need attention, alongside sexual conversation and alcohol themes; test the actual mixing controls.

Why it might click. The game uses bartending to frame a series of conversations about life in a high-tech, unequal city. Drinks influence which stories unfold. Its attraction is the contrast between large political systems and the specific people living, working, joking, and struggling inside them.

The full catch. Reading, recipe selection, and remembering customer preferences are real parts of the experience. Sexual conversation, alcohol, and adult subject matter belong to its tone. Check ingredient operations and any mixing or waiting controls rather than inferring simplicity from the visual-novel label.

Try this first. Complete one customer order with the recipe information available on screen. Then judge the conversation itself: are these people enjoyable company, and is the bar routine a satisfying rhythm rather than unwanted clerical work?

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P163 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

VA-11 Hall-A: Cyberpunk Bartender Action

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Cocktail Had No Constituency

The cyberpunk bar in VA-11 Hall-A encouraged me to invent a drink called Executive Intimacy. Shawna asked what went in it. I said expensive things served close together.

'That's the seating plan,' she said. 'Try again.'

Velvet wanted her usual drink before rehearsal, not a beverage bearing the emotional difficulties of the host. Remy wanted water. His victory fanfare involved a note he had never previously met.

I treated these as negotiating positions and began describing a glittering pitcher. Rae took the menu from my hand. 'Nigga, people already told you what they want.'

Nia ordered something for herself. Rae ordered something different. They touched glasses without establishing a joint beverage policy, a development I found administratively reckless.

The fictional customers brought their problems to a counter. Ours brought actual orders. Porsche wrote them down and handed them to the waiter before I could announce a tasting committee.

Shawna kept Executive Intimacy as a private joke. She said we could discuss the seating later.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the cyberpunk counter for customers worth hearing, with recipes and mature conversation in view. My signature cocktail remains an unwritten promise between consenting married people.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/447530/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P164 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Red Strings Club

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a cyberpunk story about emotion and influence through unusual work, conversations and choices that question what helping another person means.

What you do. Shape objects, prepare drinks, use telephone conversations and make choices while following the story's questions about emotional influence.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Object shaping can require precision; several interaction types and morally difficult themes need checking beyond the point-and-click label.

Why it might click. This cyberpunk conspiracy story asks what happiness and emotional freedom mean. Its unusual sequence of bartending, implant pottery, and phone impersonation gives those arguments different forms; you manipulate both objects and conversations while learning what a corporation intends.

The full catch. The store explicitly describes a lathe and cocktail manipulation, which makes pointer precision and held movement significant checks. This is not safely described as dialogue-only. Its emotional manipulation and corporate-control themes may also feel sharper than a relaxed conversation game.

Try this first. Inspect the first hands-on task as soon as it appears. Determine whether its movement is enjoyable and whether the offered controls work for you. A compelling ethical question is not an obligation to tolerate an irritating interface.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P164 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Red Strings Club

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Emotional Sculpture Looked Like My Ear

The Red Strings Club raised questions about shaping other people's feelings. I immediately offered the summit a sculpture intended to inspire unanimous affection for its host.

Mika rotated the clay model. 'It looks like an ear.' 'That represents listening.' 'Why is the ear wearing your watch?'

Velvet wanted a stage entrance, not an emotional adjustment. She moved the model away from the lighting diagram and asked Remy to test the microphone she actually needed.

Nia said she could draft a clause about requests. I told her my sculpture communicated without words. Rae leaned closer. 'It's communicating that you bought clay before sandwiches.'

That hurt because the sandwiches were late.

I tried squeezing the clay into a heart. It became a second ear. Tank placed the two together and said the summit finally had enough equipment to hear Rosa asking for plates.

The game could keep its difficult questions about influence. I fetched plates. Velvet thanked the technician, not my sculpture, when the microphone worked.

Aiden's verdict. Consider this story if its questions about influence interest you and its varied interactions suit. The clay ear has been retired before it acquires another procurement budget.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/589780/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P165 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Neo Cab

Edition considered: PC release

Meet passengers whose conversations reveal a troubled city, while a driver's relationships, money and emotional state complicate the choices ahead.

What you do. Read passenger exchanges, choose responses and consider the relationships, ratings and resources affected by the driver's decisions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Money, ratings and emotion restrictions create pressure; check text flow and map/menu operations despite the declared mouse-only option.

Why it might click. Neo Cab is a visual novel about Lina, a human driver in an increasingly automated city. Passengers become sources of stories and possible leads in her search. Her emotional state affects available responses, giving conversations a connection to the strain of working and surviving.

The full catch. Do not confuse its driving premise with a promise about vehicle controls: the inspected listing calls it a visual novel and declares a mouse-only option. Money, ratings, and emotion restrictions can still create pressure. Check reading flow and map/menu operations.

Try this first. Follow an early passenger conversation through to its outcome. Look at how a mood change affects the next available response. Decide whether that constraint deepens the character or makes the conversation feel less enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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P165 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Neo Cab

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Passenger Rated My Marriage Advice

Neo Cab's passengers made me offer Rae an imaginary ride across the convention floor. I rolled up in a chair, opened a nonexistent door and asked where she wanted to go.

'To the woman holding two coffees,' she said. 'Excellent. Before we arrive, a few thoughts about relationships.' 'Cancel the trip.'

Nia was only three tables away. My proposed service had already introduced a delay, a fare dispute and an unsolicited emotional assessment.

Shawna stopped the chair with one hand. 'Baby, you could just move your foot.'

I moved it. Rae walked past me, sat beside Nia and immediately received the second coffee. No application required.

The driver's relationships and money on screen still interested them. Rae asked Nia which passenger she would find hardest to hear out. Nia looked toward me, smiling into her cup.

'Aiden gets four stars,' she said. I straightened. 'Out of how many?'

Tank started laughing before she answered. That nigga had learned to recognise a meter running.

Aiden's verdict. Try the passenger conversations if the money, emotional restrictions and interface remain manageable. My chair service has suspended relationship advice while customer confidence undergoes necessary repairs.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/794540/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P166 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Eliza

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a story about scripted emotional support, work and listening, where the gap between a helpful conversation and a performance becomes interesting.

What you do. Read conversations, choose responses and follow the character's work and relationships as the story questions how support is delivered.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Substantial dialogue explores personal distress and counselling technology; check text pacing and whether the subject feels welcome tonight.

Why it might click. Eliza follows Evelyn as she works as a human proxy for an AI counseling program and reconnects with people from her past. Fully voiced characters and a contemporary setting carry questions about work, responsibility, technical power, and whether simulated care meets real needs.

The full catch. The subject includes personal distress and the limits of counseling technology. Consider whether that is welcome material tonight. Expect substantial dialogue and choices; verify text pacing and navigation. This is a fictional story, not an instruction manual for supporting another person.

Try this first. Read an early work scene and a conversation outside it. Compare the constrained professional role with Evelyn's own voice. Continue if the contrast makes you curious, rather than because the subject seems worthy enough to require homework.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P166 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Eliza

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Listening Service Wanted a Tip

Eliza's scripted support gave me an idea for improving summit hospitality. I stood beside the buffet and told Kit I understood her concern before she had expressed one.

'Where are my glasses?' she asked. 'Your feelings are valid.' 'My glasses are missing.'

I nodded with expensive sincerity. She reached past my shoulder and took them from the pocket where I had put them while demonstrating attentive listening.

Nia nearly spilled her tea. Rae passed her a napkin before I could describe the incident as a breakthrough.

Kit wanted to pick her karaoke song. She had not requested a journey through my capacity for empathy. Once she could read the list, she chose something loud enough to punish an indifferent microphone.

Mercedes asked whether Kit wanted accompaniment. 'Yes. And no announcement that I am brave.'

The story on screen could investigate the difference between listening and performing concern. Mine had developed a practical test: Kit began singing, and I remained quiet.

Shawna tipped me with half her dessert for maintaining the new service.

Aiden's verdict. Choose this dialogue-led story when its distress and counselling themes feel welcome. My listening franchise has narrowed its offering to hearing the sentence before selling a response.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/716500/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P167 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Citizen Sleeper

Edition considered: PC first game

Build a precarious life through dice and daily choices, with relationships and meaningful opportunities competing for the resources available each cycle.

What you do. Allocate dice, choose tasks, manage resources and follow relationships while deciding what can be done during each cycle.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. No timed input is declared, but resource shortages, cycle clocks and interconnected choices create substantial planning pressure.

Why it might click. Citizen Sleeper turns life on a crowded station into choices about work, friendships, resources, and survival. Assigning dice creates a clear connection between what you can do this cycle and what you care about. Its characters make those allocations feel personal rather than merely numerical.

The full catch. Steam declares playable without timed input, but the story uses resource pressure and advancing clocks. Several systems and ongoing relationships need attention. That declaration does not verify hold-free controls; inspect dice placement, text size, and the station interface.

Try this first. Spend one cycle slowly, explaining to yourself what each chosen action will cost or advance. Meet somebody whose situation interests you. Notice whether the limited opportunities feel engaging or like a second schedule to manage.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P167 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Citizen Sleeper

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Dice Refused to Sponsor My Portrait

Citizen Sleeper's scarce resources made the remaining summit budget look less like a number and more like several people waiting for dinner. I proposed solving this with confidence.

Rae counted the available dessert portions. Nia counted the guests. Tank counted again because he disliked the first answer.

'We could cut my portrait lighting,' I said generously. Shawna checked the bill. 'That has its own battery.' 'Nigga, I invested in resilience.'

Mika suggested moving the spare flowers and using their table for additional plates. Velvet offered to shorten her costume reveal if it got the cooks another clear path.

Everybody was finding something useful to give. I had contributed an illuminated explanation of why my contribution was difficult.

The daily choices on screen carried needs that could not all disappear through enthusiasm. I paid for the extra desserts.

Rae saved Nia a seat and half a tart. Nia split it unevenly in Rae's favour. Tank watched this resource allocation with professional respect.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the precarious life if resource planning sounds meaningful, remembering that untimed choices can still carry pressure. The portrait's independent power supply does not make it dinner.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC first game. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1578650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P168 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Citizen Sleeper 2: Starward Vector

Edition considered: PC sequel

Travel with a crew through uncertain contracts, where imperfect dice and limited resources make shared needs and consequences part of the story.

What you do. Choose contracts, allocate dice, manage crew concerns and resources, and respond to stress and damaged dice as journeys develop.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Crew systems, stress, contracts and damaged dice add heavy tracking despite declared untimed play and adjustable difficulty.

Why it might click. The sequel expands the dice-driven roleplaying into travel, crew-building, and contracts across an asteroid belt. A battered ship can become a home, while temporary jobs bring distinct characters and risks. The appeal is making a future through relationships as well as careful decisions.

The full catch. The current Steam record declares adjustable difficulty and play without timed input. It also describes stress, damaged dice, and multi-cycle contracts: waiting for you is not the same as removing consequences. Inspect the actual difficulty choices before relying on them.

Try this first. Learn one contract's objective, available dice, and stress consequences before committing actions. Try a manageable early job and ask whether preparing with a crew adds pleasure or too many interconnected things to track.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P168 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Citizen Sleeper 2: Starward Vector

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Crew Declined My Inspirational Luggage

Citizen Sleeper 2 put an uncertain crew journey before us. I decided our signing team needed a name, matching bags and a statement about carrying each other.

Remy held up the bag I had ordered. Its handle came off. 'Are we starting with the metaphor broken?'

Mika wanted the spare cable inside it. Velvet wanted the cash envelope for the performers. Rae wanted the table stabiliser we had somehow packed beneath my commemorative slippers.

I said all missions suffered unexpected stress. Nia examined the slippers. 'Some stress arrives with a monogram.'

The game's imperfect dice and contracts gave everybody enough genuine uncertainty to discuss. Our own crew did not need an additional challenge locating equipment in my personality.

Tank tipped the bag gently onto the sofa. Everything appeared at once. Rae fixed the table leg; Remy connected the microphone; Velvet counted her envelope and grinned.

I wore the slippers. Shawna called them excellent for the short voyage between the sofa and whatever useful thing she asked me to fetch.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the crew story if damaged dice, stress and contracts invite thought rather than exhaustion. My inspirational luggage works best when removed from the equipment it supposedly supports.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC sequel. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/2442460/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P169 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Disco Elysium - The Final Cut

Edition considered: PC Final Cut

Investigate through conversations and competing inner voices, with unusual characters, roleplaying choices and a darkly funny world giving the detective story depth.

What you do. Explore scenes, question people, read or hear dialogue and make choices shaped by the detective's different skills and impulses.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Extensive dialogue, skill checks and inventory/character menus add substantial work; not every interaction is verified as untimed or hold-free.

Why it might click. The Final Cut presents a dense, voiced detective roleplaying story about a damaged investigator and a politically complicated city. Skills become argumentative inner voices, making character-building part of the writing. Conversations can be funny, cruel, revealing, and unexpectedly tender.

The full catch. Expect extensive dialogue, skill checks, inventory and character menus, and mature material including addiction and violence. A failed choice can have consequences. The manually checked source confirms the Final Cut edition, but does not certify all interactions as untimed or hold-free.

Try this first. Follow an early conversation and inspect one relevant skill explanation. Decide whether the competing voices delight you or interrupt the person you want to hear. Treat the opening as a test of tone as much as controls.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P169 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Disco Elysium - The Final Cut

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Inner Voices Lost the Microphone

Disco Elysium's competing inner voices made me feel represented. One part of me wanted the summit to finish. Another wanted my closing entrance accompanied by thunder.

'Which part ordered the smoke?' Shawna asked. 'Artistic judgment.' 'The hotel calls it a cleaning surcharge.'

Velvet said the smoke belonged to her number, which she had actually rehearsed. Remy backed her until he remembered his own fanfare needed the same technician.

Nia asked whether either performance needed to precede the final wording. Both performers said no. My thunder suddenly had no surviving relative.

Rae borrowed Kit's glasses to read a small line. Kit said she could borrow them only if somebody remembered where they went. I announced that a detective was among them.

'Find the pen you're holding, nigga,' Tank said.

The game offered a rich investigation. Our immediate mystery solved itself when I lowered my hand. Nia took the pen, read the disputed sentence aloud and left my weather system out of it.

Aiden's verdict. Enter the detective's crowded mind if dialogue, checks and menus appeal. Our host's inner thunder has been overruled by the people who brought an actual working microphone.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected Steam app632470 on 2026-09-20, exact title Disco Elysium - The Final Cut. Source supports full English voice acting, skills, roleplaying choices, and mature content. Control and workload judgments remain editorial.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/632470/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P170 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

NORCO

Edition considered: PC release

Investigate a family mystery in a distinctive industrial landscape, where conversations, local detail and strange events make the place itself compelling to explore.

What you do. Explore scenes, talk to characters, inspect clues and work through the story's puzzles and other interactive sequences.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense themes and puzzles add work, and the source mentions fights; do not assume it is exclusively quiet dialogue.

Why it might click. NORCO combines a missing-person search with family history, industrial landscapes, and increasingly strange science fiction in South Louisiana. Its dialogue-focused point-and-click structure invites attention to both particular characters and the forces shaping their world.

The full catch. The official description also mentions puzzles and fights; do not treat dialogue-focused as proof that every sequence is mechanically quiet. Expect dense imagery, unfamiliar connections, and bereavement. Check each new interaction type and the text/interface size.

Try this first. Explore an early location and follow one clue about the missing brother. Pause to decide whether the place feels intriguing in its own right. Inspect the first unfamiliar mechanical sequence before assuming later play matches the opening.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P170 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

NORCO

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Scenic Backdrop Needed a Break

NORCO's industrial landscape had Rae talking about the street behind her workshop. A place could carry history without putting it in a gold frame. I looked at our summit backdrop.

It showed my face floating over a fictional skyline. Several buildings were taller than necessary to support the emotional claim.

'Where's the loading entrance?' Rosa asked. 'This is aspirational geography.' 'The caterer is aspirationally waiting outside.'

Rae described the little lunch counter by her shop. Nia wanted to visit. Rae said Thursdays had the good soup and the least theatrical customers.

I offered to arrange a limousine. 'You can recommend a soup without acquiring transport,' Shawna told me.

Porsche unhooked one side of the backdrop so the carts could pass. My enormous eye folded neatly against a palm tree.

The family mystery on screen kept its strange, complicated place. Our room became a little more specific too: food coming through, people making plans, and one floating face learning to leave a gap.

Aiden's verdict. Visit NORCO for its distinctive place and mystery if the dense themes and varied demands suit. My imaginary skyline has acquired a practical and deeply necessary loading entrance.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected public Steam primary description and category declarations for PC release. Premise and listed features are source-supported; control workload, memory and mood routing are editorial judgments, not completion testing. Absent co-op or timed-input declarations remain unknown.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1221250/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

The Dance Was Not a Reward for Being Useful

Nia's invitation reached Rae just as Kit asked whether Rae could fix the little light above the karaoke screen. Rae had spent most of the evening making objects less likely to collapse. She put the note down without reading it and reached for her tools.

Nia covered the tool bag with her hand.

'You can say no,' she said.

Kit looked from one woman to the other. 'I asked. I didn't issue an order.'

'Then let her answer before you tell the technician she's coming.'

The technician stood behind Kit holding a ladder. Nigga, witnesses had developed terrible timing.

I offered to buy another light. All three women ignored me with impressive coordination.

Rae took her hand off the bag. 'I don't want to climb anything. I want to read this note.'

Kit turned to the technician. 'I'm sorry. I assumed.' He nodded and carried the ladder toward the lamp. Kit watched him go. 'We already had this argument over the fees. Apparently I can understand a budget faster than I can stop doing it.'

The less practical problem stayed.

'You could have told me,' Kit said.

'I just did.'

Nia moved her hand away. Rae did not pick up the tools.

Kit was white, butch, wearing a carefully chosen suit and the expression of somebody discovering that a useful intention had arrived badly. Rae was a Black stud with a mechanic's hands and several very specific reasons to dislike being treated as the room's available solution.

I had printed their labels across opposite sides of a banner. It looked impressive from the lift. Up close it had done a remarkably poor job of explaining either woman.

'When I walk into a room like this,' Kit said, 'I already feel as though people are waiting for me to prove I can be useful. I thought we were doing the same thing.'

'We can recognise something without having the same night,' Rae replied.

Kit folded her arms, caught herself and let them drop. 'I know that.'

'You might. You still sent the ladder.'

Velvet sat on the edge of the table. She had heard enough to stop arranging her entrance and start listening.

Kit looked at Rae's tool bag. 'I liked that you seemed certain. You knew what to do with the table. I was still trying to ask for the right light without apologising for having a face.'

'You thought certainty meant I wasn't tired.'

'Maybe.'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Rae looked at the note beneath her hand. 'Sometimes I like fixing things. Sometimes I like being good at something in front of a woman I want. Both can be true, and I can still want the next person to leave the screwdriver alone.'

Nia smiled, but only briefly.

'You don't have to earn this chair,' she said.

Rae turned toward her. 'I know.'

'Do you?'

The room got quiet enough for my portrait's ventilation fan to sound obscene.

I reached for its switch. Shawna pointed to the correct one before I blacked out the entire floor.

Nia waited until the fan stopped. 'I like the way you look at me. I like your terrible opinions about the biscuits. I wanted to flirt with you. Then every time something happened, I became the person who could make your answer sound diplomatic.'

'I didn't ask you to do that,' Rae said.

'No. I did it. I'm stopping.'

She put the marked-up draft on the table. The gesture was small. Rae watched it as though Nia had moved a wall.

'I'm Black, trans, a lesbian, a femme and a lawyer,' Nia said. 'Tonight you have all managed to remember the lawyer whenever a sentence becomes awkward. I would like the woman in the nice dress to get a turn.'

Velvet lifted her glass. 'The dress has been waiting patiently.'

Nia laughed. Rae did not reach for a polished reply.

'I don't want you to translate me,' she said. 'I want you to tell me when I'm being an ass. Preferably before it becomes a programme item.'

'You're being an ass about accepting help.'

'Excellent. Efficient. No billable preamble.'

Kit sat, leaving room between their chairs instead of turning the whole exchange into a panel.

'I don't want the banner to decide what I can ask you,' she said. 'But I can see I've been using same side when I meant please recognise me.'

Rae nodded. 'Ask for that. Don't send equipment.'

June arrived with tea and looked at the banner. 'White butches over here, Black studs over there. Where did you intend to put my Black butch ass?'

I began to explain visual balance.

'Try the chair,' June said, and sat wherever she pleased.

Dez followed. She put the borrowed jacket over June's chair and took the cup June offered her. The banner had lost another jurisdiction.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

Kit looked at June. 'I grew up thinking there was one way to look like I belonged. Then I spent years resenting people who looked at ease in it.'

'Who looked at ease?' June asked.

Kit laughed despite herself. 'Fair.'

'I like being butch,' Kit continued. 'I like how my shoulders sit in this jacket. I like a woman calling me handsome without sounding surprised by her own taste. I don't want to speak about all of it as damage.'

'Good,' Rae said. 'Because the jacket looks good. I noticed before we argued.'

Kit looked pleased, then slightly embarrassed by how pleased. Nia told her to enjoy the compliment without preparing a counterstatement.

Rae rubbed one hand over her knee. 'Stud is my word. It doesn't mean I'm volunteering to be a man in somebody else's romance. It doesn't mean I don't want tenderness because I like this shirt.'

Nia touched the cuff, waiting until Rae turned her hand toward hers.

'I like this shirt too,' she said. 'I also like when you stop arranging the space around me long enough to ask where I want to stand.'

'I was trying to make a path.'

'I know. Sometimes I want the path. Sometimes I want your hand. They're different requests.'

I felt Shawna glance at me. Nigga, a lesson had crossed the room without my name appearing anywhere in it.

Remy came over carrying the working microphone. He had missed the start, asked what was happening and accepted Kit's short answer instead of inventing one.

'My gay friends sometimes introduce me as the one who understands women,' he said. 'I'm a man with one particular history. I'm not a customer-service desk for everybody they date.'

Velvet nodded. 'And I put on a queen because I want this room watching the number I rehearsed. That doesn't entitle anybody to invent the rest of my life from the costume.'

'They do enjoy a convenient character,' Kit said.

'So do I,' Velvet replied. 'Mine charges.'

The joke loosened something without ending the conversation. Kit asked Rae whether she wanted another coffee. Rae said water. Kit brought water and did not make the correction into a test of her goodness.

Nia finally picked up the note. 'Now can somebody tell me whether this invitation is legible?'

Rae read it sideways. 'Are you asking me to dance or to inspect a second table?'

'Dance.'

'Then ask.'

'Will you dance with me after the signing?'

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

'Yes. And if I'm nervous, don't let me pretend I need to check the furniture.'

Nia smiled fully. 'If I'm nervous, don't let me turn it into a contract.'

'You can both be nervous,' Shawna said. 'The floor will cope.'

Rae looked at Nia's hand. 'When we get there, will you hold me first? I keep reaching like I'm supposed to know the whole way.'

'I'd like that,' Nia said. She offered her hand, palm up. Rae took it. Nothing about her shirt, her name or her chosen word needed altering for the gesture to fit.

I offered to have the floor inspected. Shawna put one finger against my lips.

Mercedes asked what song they wanted. They chose together. Kit wanted her own song afterwards; Velvet wanted the time she had booked; Remy wanted his ridiculous fanfare to survive being funny.

Nobody's desire dissolved into the couple's. The room held several wants at once, untidily, without arranging them into opposing armies.

Rae folded the note and kept it. Nia asked why. 'Because you made a bad drawing of a good question,' Rae said.

'That's my handwriting.'

'I know. I'm learning it.'

I looked at the banner again. Its enormous words could still sell a theatrical war. They could not do this part: two women admitting what the pose concealed, another recognising what she had assumed, and June refusing to move to make my categories prettier.

I asked Mika to lower it before the music. Mika asked where to put it.

Shawna pointed at my portrait's transport crate. 'Plenty of room for another oversized explanation.'

Nigga, I held the crate open myself.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P171 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Kentucky Route Zero

Edition considered: PC complete five-act edition

Follow an unusual theatrical journey where conversations, working lives and strange places matter as much as finding out what happens next.

What you do. Explore scenes, choose conversation responses and follow the people met along a mysterious delivery route.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Expect substantial reading and ambiguity; the existing source does not certify every timing or held-input demand.

Why it might click. This five-act magical-realist adventure follows a delivery into a world of strange roads, precarious work, debts, and fragile communities. Its pleasure lies in language, staging, music, and atmosphere. Choices can feel like shaping a performance rather than selecting the correct solution to a puzzle.

The full catch. Expect substantial reading, ambiguity, and a pace that may feel deliberately indirect. The PC Edition has been manually matched to the assigned complete game. Check movement and text advance; no inspected source establishes every scene as free of held or timed input.

Try this first. Stay with one early encounter rather than trying to solve the whole world's meaning. Notice whether choosing a line makes you feel involved. If the theatrical distance leaves you cold, that is useful taste information, not a reading failure.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P171 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Kentucky Route Zero

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Route Went Through My Introduction

Kentucky Route Zero's strange working journey inspired Mika to describe our evening as a passage through temporary architecture. I thought that sounded expensive enough to approve.

Then a waiter asked which door reached the kitchen. Mika pointed at the floor plan. The waiter pointed at the actual wall.

'That door exists in the earlier drawing,' Mika said. 'My tray exists now,' the waiter replied.

Rae moved a folding screen. An ordinary door emerged behind it. I announced a discovery. 'Nigga, it has EXIT written over it,' Tank said.

Nia liked how the game left space around what people meant. She asked Rae about the longest ride she had ever taken without a particular destination.

Rae told her. I tried to improve the story by adding a helicopter. Shawna squeezed my hand with the exact pressure required to land it.

The waiter returned with dinner. Mika abandoned the drawing, kept the beautiful lighting and opened the route that actually went somewhere. Our strange journey had found the potatoes.

Aiden's verdict. Take the theatrical journey if ambiguity and reading appeal. The summit map now recognises the kitchen door, although my helicopter remains available in several entirely imaginary jurisdictions.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected Steam app231200, Kentucky Route Zero: PC Edition; the five-act PC edition matches this assigned game despite title-review flag. Other control and mood judgments remain provisional.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/231200/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P172 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Night in the Woods

Edition considered: PC release

Revisit friendships in a changing hometown, where funny conversations and ordinary outings lead into a more unsettling story about belonging.

What you do. Move through town, talk with friends, explore familiar places and take part in activities along the story.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Movement includes platforming and other active sequences; a strong character story does not remove those control demands.

Why it might click. Night in the Woods offers the company of young adults negotiating friendship, disappointment, work, and changes in their hometown. Its animal characters carry recognizably human conversations, with a mystery growing around the edges of daily wandering.

The full catch. Movement and platforming are part of its adventure structure, and additional activity types require checking. Do not file it as a static visual novel. Its themes can be bleak, including economic decline and emotional distress, despite the bright designs and frequent jokes.

Try this first. Walk through an early stretch of town and talk to somebody who knows Mae. Test the movement before investing in the story. Decide whether the everyday conversations are reward enough for the amount of traversal between them.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P172 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Night in the Woods

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Homecoming Band Had Already Replaced Me

Night in the Woods brought old friendships and a changing hometown into the room. Kit remembered the terrible band she had joined in her twenties.

'What did you play?' Remy asked. 'Bass. What did you play?' 'A duke once. Reviews were divided.'

June remembered the Blue Comet band playing it in 1967. Dez said there had been a jukebox, not a band. 'It sounded live,' June insisted. 'So did you,' Dez replied.

I offered to join their reunion. Kit asked what instrument I played. I said atmosphere. 'We already had a broken amplifier,' she replied.

Rae leaned against Nia's chair and listened. Nia kept time with her pen, producing a tiny rhythm and three additional dots on the final wording.

The game's active movement still needed its own trial. The music in our room needed no intervention from me. Velvet took the chorus, Kit laughed through a forgotten bridge, and even the waiter waited.

I supplied the last note by dropping a spoon. Nobody invited it back.

Aiden's verdict. Meet the hometown friends if the story interests you and the active sections fit. My proposed reunion role has been reduced to transporting instruments without performing atmosphere.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/481510/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P173 / A PLACE TO START

Beacon Pines

Edition considered: PC release

Explore a branching storybook mystery where discovering and choosing particular words can change what happens to its characters in meaningful ways.

What you do. Move through the setting, talk to characters, collect useful words and try them at branching moments.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Branch tracking and creepy events remain despite untimed-play declarations; test walking and menu selection for held-input demands.

Why it might click. Beacon Pines combines exploring a small town with collecting word charms and revisiting branches through a story tree. New words can transform a moment and open different events. Curiosity about how a sentence changes the world becomes part of solving its mystery.

The full catch. The Steam record declares play without timed input and keyboard-only operation. Branch tracking still adds a memory burden, and the cute art accompanies creepy events. Those declarations do not establish that every control avoids holds; test ordinary walking and menu selection.

Try this first. Collect an early charm and use it at a turning point. Then inspect how the story tree represents the route. Continue if comparing possibilities feels like discovery rather than keeping several unfinished stories in your head.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P173 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Beacon Pines

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / One Word Made the Proposal Considerably Worse

Beacon Pines made choosing a word seem like an excellent way to influence a story. I examined the summit sentence promising an enjoyable evening and suggested replacing enjoyable with legendary. Nia said it described an intention, not a warranty. I suggested inevitable. Rae put down her cup. 'You want to guarantee fun now?' 'I want strong language.' 'Nigga, this is strong: sit down.' Kit offered optional. Velvet preferred paid, but admitted she was looking at a different paragraph. Remy proposed resplendent and pronounced it as though it came with its own trumpet. Shawna asked what the sentence needed to do. Nia read it again without any of our ornaments. Everybody understood it.

On screen, the words could send a mystery along another branch. Ours had nearly sent a modest invitation into the insurance department.

I accepted enjoyable. Rae wrote a separate word on Nia's napkin: later. Nia read it, looked toward the dance floor and stopped considering resplendent.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the branching word mystery if its story and tracking suit. Our charter retains ordinary language, while the evening's most effective amendment fits on a napkin.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1269640/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P174 / A PLACE TO START

Mutazione

Edition considered: PC release

Spend time in an unusual community through conversations and gardening, with music helping give the people and their surroundings a distinctive mood.

What you do. Explore the community, speak with residents and tend gardens as their interconnected stories develop around you.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Illness, family secrets and community conflict matter; verify the declared untimed, input and saving options on the installed version.

Why it might click. Mutazione follows Kai visiting her grandfather in an unusual island community. Conversations, old tensions, and musical gardens sit alongside the supernatural plot. Its attraction is spending enough time with a place that the relationships begin to matter.

The full catch. Illness, family secrets, and community conflict are central; gentle presentation is not a promise of emotionally light material. Steam declares no timed input, mouse-only and keyboard-only options, and save-anytime. Verify those options on the installed version and inspect ordinary navigation.

Try this first. Meet one resident and spend time with an early garden interaction. Judge the balance between conversation and moving through the community. If you like it, a note of the next person to visit may make returning easier.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P174 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Mutazione

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Garden Refused My Opening Address

Mutazione's conversations and musical gardens gave Mercedes an idea for the corner beside the signing table. She wanted a quiet place to hear a song after the crowd thinned.

I ordered a decorative tree. It arrived with blinking lights and a speaker inside the trunk. Nigga, even my foliage had an introduction.

Mika loved it for nine seconds. Then the tree announced a discount on spa treatments in the middle of Mercedes's melody.

Kit found its switch. Rae shifted two chairs into the corner. Nia sat in one and asked Rae whether the other was reserved.

'Depends,' Rae said. 'You planning to sell me a facial?'

The community on screen had lives beyond what a visitor first noticed. Our corner acquired its own little history: a bad purchase, an excellent song and two women staying after the joke.

I carried the unplugged tree toward the service lift. Shawna walked beside me. 'Beautiful branches,' she said. 'Thank you.' 'I meant your arms. Keep carrying.'

Aiden's verdict. Visit the unusual community when conversation, gardening and its heavier themes sound welcome. The summit's musical tree will remain unplugged until it develops an ear for other people.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1080750/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P175 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Wytchwood

Edition considered: PC release

Gather strange ingredients and craft useful things while a witch's errands lead through an illustrated world of stories, creatures and connected tasks.

What you do. Explore locations, collect ingredients, follow recipes and return with crafted items to advance different characters' requests.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Nested recipes, repeated travel and monsters add work; keeping several ingredient chains in mind can become demanding.

Why it might click. Wytchwood turns gothic fairy-tale errands into gathering and crafting. The witch's judgments give the recipes personality: ingredients are steps toward changing a troublesome situation, not simply collecting for its own sake. The illustrated world helps make each place distinctive.

The full catch. Expect repeated travel, nested recipes, and remembering where resources come from. The official description includes monsters and overcoming them through tools and spells; do not assume that crafting removes all hazards or movement demands. Check inventory and held movement.

Try this first. Follow one early recipe from request to ingredients to use. Notice whether retracing a route is satisfying familiarity or unwanted repetition. The useful trial is the whole small crafting loop, not just admiring the art.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P175 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wytchwood

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Recipe Required a Different Host

Wytchwood's ingredient chains made me claim that a good evening was simply a recipe. Velvet asked for the recipe's payment stage. Rosa asked about its missing forks.

I listed music, friendship, lighting and a mysterious spark. Rae lifted the empty fork basket. 'Can you eat with the spark?'

Nia was drafting one final sentence while Mika looked for the tape needed to secure the tablecloth. The tape was in the box beneath the ribbons I had ordered to conceal the table legs.

The ribbons required scissors. The scissors were on the piano. The piano was occupied by Remy's enormous hat, whose storage apparently required an instrument.

Tank moved the hat, retrieved the scissors and produced the tape. Rosa produced forks from a drawer I had decorated shut.

The witch could keep gathering her strange ingredients. Our summit had enough nested errands without adding my theory of ambiance.

Shawna handed me the ribbon scraps. 'Your spark needs clearing off the floor.' I began the next recipe: husband, bin, silence.

Aiden's verdict. Try the witch's errands if collecting and recipe chains feel satisfying. My hospitality recipe has been simplified until it includes forks before any reference to mysterious sparks.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/729000/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P176 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Wandersong

Edition considered: PC release

Meet a colourful world through a bard's singing, with music and character encounters giving an active adventure its playful and emotional shape.

What you do. Move through scenes, sing to interact with the world and handle platforming as the adventure continues.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. This is an active platforming detour; warm music and artwork do not remove real-time movement and reaction demands.

Why it might click. Wandersong builds a characterful adventure around a bard who changes things through music. Its humor, unusual interactions, and emotional story can make singing feel like a way of meeting the world. The official pitch also explicitly calls it a platforming adventure.

The full catch. Directional movement, platforming, and selecting musical responses are meaningful demands. The developer's broad accessibility language about color and sound does not answer every motor-input question. This is a contrasting option for someone who wants those active elements, not a guaranteed quiet story.

Try this first. Try an early singing interaction and a small piece of traversal. Check whether choosing the notes and moving through the space are enjoyable. If either feels like an obstacle, keep the musical premise separate from the actual fit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P176 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Wandersong

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Bard Asked Me to Stop Conducting

Wandersong put a singing bard before us. Remy immediately offered a preview of the victory fanfare. It began with a pun about major agreements and minor concessions.

Kit stared at him over her glasses. 'You rehearsed that?' 'Repeatedly.' 'I can hear the damage.'

Mercedes found a key that suited his voice. Velvet added a ridiculous harmony. Soon the little rehearsal had more life than the grand recording I had commissioned for the doors.

I rose to conduct. Three people stopped singing.

'Nigga, you cannot lead a song by threatening the ceiling,' Velvet said.

Rae asked Nia whether this was the music she had imagined for their dance. Nia said she had imagined fewer puns, but she remained open to evidence.

The game's musical warmth did not erase its active adventure. Our musical problem was easier: I sat down. Remy finished the fanfare, Kit joined the last phrase, and Mercedes made the absurd thing land.

Shawna applauded. I applauded too, carefully keeping both hands below leadership level.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the bard's journey if its real-time movement also appeals. The summit fanfare survives, while my conducting career has ended before the ceiling could file a complaint.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/530320/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P177 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Chicory: A Colorful Tale

Edition considered: PC release

Paint and explore a world where colour, creativity and a character's personal story develop together, with an optional second person helping paint.

What you do. Move through the world, colour scenes, solve obstacles and try the different available painting roles with a companion.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Native co-op in this edition

Main catch. Painting, movement and active sequences need checking, and the two cooperative roles do not offer identical control.

Why it might click. Chicory is a coloring-book adventure about taking up an artist's brush. Painting changes the environment and supports puzzles, while the story explores creativity and the people around it. The official listing explicitly includes local cooperative painting.

The full catch. Painting, directional movement, and more active sequences need separate checks. Local co-op does not necessarily give both people identical roles. Inspect brush behavior and the game's actual options before deciding whether the action is welcome; no assumed setting is required by this card.

Try this first. Color one small area and use paint for an early puzzle. If playing together, establish who controls movement and who paints. The point is to discover whether making marks feels playful without turning the result into an art assessment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P177 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Chicory: A Colorful Tale

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Colour Scheme Had a Personal Grievance

Chicory's painting made Mika wonder whether the signing backdrop needed one final splash of colour. I offered gold. Everybody looked at the gold table, gold frame and gold bowl.

'Something we haven't already swallowed,' Rae said.

Kit wanted cool light for her song. Velvet wanted warmth for her costume. Porsche adjusted one lamp while Mercedes stood where the performers would actually be seen.

I tried settling it by declaring gold neutral. Nia asked neutral toward what. 'My taste,' I said. 'That's one of the parties,' she replied.

The game's painting helper did not occupy the same role as its main player. Our decorators had different jobs too, which became obvious when I touched a control and turned the curtains purple.

Velvet liked it. Kit hated it. Mika saved the setting for Velvet's number and restored Kit's.

Two looks. One room. Nigga, they had solved the dispute without commissioning a sculpture. I asked for a photograph before anybody improved it further.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the painted world if its actions and unequal helper roles fit. Our lighting compromise permits two tastes and has temporarily removed my thumb from the control panel.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1123450/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P178 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Rakuen

Edition considered: PC release

A hospital story opens into a fantastical world, connecting exploration and puzzles with the lives and feelings of people encountered along the way.

What you do. Guide the character through scenes, speak with people, explore the storybook world and solve puzzles that connect their stories.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Illness and grief are central, while non-combat play still includes movement, navigation and puzzle demands that need checking.

Why it might click. Rakuen follows a boy and his mother as helping people in a fantasy world reveals the lives of people around him. Music and character stories connect the two settings. The developer explicitly describes a non-combat adventure with puzzles and dialogue-based mysteries.

The full catch. Hospital life, illness, grief, and unfinished relationships are central themes. Non-combat does not mean no navigation or difficult puzzle. Check walking, object interaction, text advance, and any eerie sections; decide separately whether the emotional subject is welcome.

Try this first. Explore a small early area and speak with one person. Test the ordinary movement and the way information is presented. Continue for interest in the people, with permission to stop before an emotional scene feels like an obligation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P178 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Rakuen

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Quiet Corner Had Actual Company

Rakuen's hospital story changed the room's pace. Rosa wanted to hear the beginning. Tank sat beside her without reaching for the microphone somebody had left on the chair.

I began to explain why a powerful story required respectful attention. Shawna gently removed the microphone from my own hand. Apparently I had acquired it during the explanation.

Rae asked Nia whether she wanted company or a little space. 'Company,' Nia said. Rae settled beside her.

Across the room, Velvet needed a clasp repaired before performing. Kit took her glasses off, realised she needed them for the clasp, and put them back on with considerable dignity.

The game could carry illness and grief without our summit turning them into a test of anybody's seriousness. Rosa watched until she wanted to stop. Tank asked about tea.

I went to fetch it and returned with the correct number of cups. No announcement. Shawna made room for me.

Later, Velvet thanked Kit from the stage. Her clasp stayed shut; my mouth mostly followed its example.

Aiden's verdict. Consider Rakuen if its grief and illness themes feel welcome alongside exploration and puzzles. Tonight's quiet corner offers company without charging anyone an explanation for leaving.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/559210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P179 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

To the Moon

Edition considered: PC original release

Follow a person's memories toward a final wish, discovering how small details change the meaning of an emotionally focused story over time.

What you do. Explore scenes from a life, examine important objects and follow conversations that gradually connect the memories.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Bereavement and emotional revelations matter; non-combat storytelling still leaves movement and particular interaction sequences to check.

Why it might click. To the Moon follows two doctors working backward through a dying man's memories to understand and fulfill his final wish. Its compact story links small details across a life. Music and changing context supply much of the emotional effect.

The full catch. The developer describes a non-combat experience, but movement, searching for objects, and puzzle interfaces remain. Bereavement and questions about memory and relationships carry significant emotional weight. Verify text advance and the particular PC version rather than assuming all ports behave alike.

Try this first. Play through an early memory investigation, noticing whether gathering its clues supports your curiosity. There is no need to solve the eventual meaning in advance. Check whether the dialogue rhythm and movement let the story land comfortably.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P179 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

To the Moon

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / My Final Wish Had an Itemised Estimate

To the Moon's journey through memories prompted Remy to ask what single moment we would preserve. I chose my entrance before the question had reached its full stop.

June chose lending Dez her jacket in 1967. Dez chose June pretending she had not offered it because Dez was cold. Both claimed the better memory. Neither reached for the coat.

Nia chose something nobody else had noticed: Rae quietly repairing the wobble in a stranger's chair, then acting as if furniture routinely cured itself.

Rae looked down at her hands. 'You remember that?' 'I was watching you,' Nia said.

I nearly offered a professional photographer. Porsche caught my eye and shook her head. Even my generosity had learned to arrive with too much equipment.

The game's emotional revelations deserved room to unfold. So did the little revelation beside us. Rae touched Nia's wrist and left her hand there.

I changed my answer to dinner. Shawna smiled. 'Which part?' 'The part where you stayed.'

She leaned against me. Nigga, I finally found a memory that did not need a larger screen.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the memory story if its emotional weight and interactions suit. My preserved summit moment has been revised to include another person doing something besides applauding me.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC original release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/206440/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P180 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Finding Paradise

Edition considered: PC release

Discover a life through memories and conflicting wishes, with a standalone story that gives its character's contradictions room to matter and develop.

What you do. Explore remembered scenes, examine significant objects and follow conversations that reveal the circumstances behind a difficult wish.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Reading, walking and details that matter later require attention, while end-of-life material remains central to the story.

Why it might click. Finding Paradise is a standalone follow-up in the memory-traversing series. The doctors investigate Colin's life and a wish whose apparent contradictions invite a closer look. It offers another character-centered story about how a life can mean more than its neatest explanation.

The full catch. Expect reading, walking, and attention to details that gain significance later. End-of-life material remains central. The publisher says previous games are not required, but that does not establish identical controls or a complete absence of unusual sequences.

Try this first. Follow the first substantial memory scene and identify one question you want answered. Check ordinary movement and dialogue handling. Let the uncertainty be part of the pleasure rather than trying to create a complete timeline immediately.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P180 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Finding Paradise

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Paradise Needed One Less Trumpet

Finding Paradise's conflicting wishes gave the table a question worth arguing about: what would make the rest of tonight perfect?

Velvet wanted her full fee and the last chorus. Kit wanted karaoke without a spotlight making her look like a witness. Remy wanted the fanfare nobody had authorised him to play twice.

Rae wanted Nia to stop rewriting their dance invitation as though it might be appealed. Nia wanted Rae to understand that the extra sentence was a joke.

I wanted everybody to get everything. Mika asked whether that included my trumpet player. Shawna said the trumpet player had already gone home.

The contradictions in the memory story were not going to resolve because I announced harmony. Neither were ours. We chose an order, left gaps and let the second fanfare go.

Nia folded the invitation and took Rae's hand instead. The message became considerably easier to read.

I accepted a trumpet-free ending. My wife promised it would leave us more interesting things to hear.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the contradictory wishes if the reading and end-of-life story appeal. Our perfect evening now permits different desires, and its trumpeter has been released into a separate paradise.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; input workload and preference routing are editorial judgments. No full-playthrough, no-hold, or universal no-timer certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/337340/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P181 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Impostor Factory

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a strange murder-and-memory story in which familiar situations twist into something unexpected, with a standalone narrative and unsettling comic touches throughout.

What you do. Explore scenes, examine objects and follow conversations as the story rearranges what familiar events appear to mean.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Its time-loop premise does not establish actual timer behavior; movement, interaction sequences and disturbing material still need checking.

Why it might click. Impostor Factory begins with a strange party and a time-loop murder mystery, then develops into a broader narrative. Its mixture of absurd comedy and emotional storytelling makes it a candidate for someone who enjoys being led somewhere they did not initially expect.

The full catch. The publisher permits independent play but notes that series order affects the experience. Expect reading, walking, deaths, and disturbing imagery within the mystery. The time-loop premise does not itself verify the absence of timed tasks or unfamiliar input sequences.

Try this first. Follow the opening invitation and inspect an early area without looking up the eventual explanation. Check movement and dialogue handling. Decide whether the strange humor earns your trust before committing to the story's later changes of direction.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P181 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Impostor Factory

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Second Entrance Cost the Same as the First

Impostor Factory's looping strangeness made Mika suggest replaying our opening entrance for the camera. I agreed, thrilled to discover time travel with a booking number.

Rae stayed seated. 'I saw it.' 'This version will be definitive.' 'The first version was sufficiently loud.'

Nia offered to play the astonished witness. She delivered a gasp so extravagantly false that Velvet immediately asked whether she wanted paid stage work.

I backed through the doors. Remy played the wrong fanfare. The photographer's battery died just as Tank brought in a tray of sandwiches.

Everybody turned toward the sandwiches. Again.

The game's murder-and-memory twists remained its own business. Our recurring mystery concerned why I kept expecting a room full of hungry adults to prefer my arrival to bread.

On the third attempt, Shawna met me at the door and kissed me instead. The photographer found a spare battery too late.

'We could repeat that,' I whispered. 'After you stop calling it definitive,' she said. I abandoned the entrance and kept the possibility.

Aiden's verdict. Try the unsettling standalone story if its twists and interactions appeal. My repeated entrance has been replaced by something worth repeating without a photographer or a fanfare.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1182620/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P182 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

A Bird Story

Edition considered: PC release

A short, largely wordless story uses animation and small interactions to follow a boy and a bird through an imaginative, emotional experience.

What you do. Guide the character through brief scenes and follow the changing relationship through gestures, movement and visual events.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Little reading does not remove movement or input checks; this is a compact interactive story rather than a complex mystery.

Why it might click. A Bird Story is a short, wordless interactive animation about a boy and an injured bird. Its small scale and reliance on images make it distinct from the more dialogue-heavy games nearby. The developer explicitly presents it as an experiment, not To the Moon's sequel.

The full catch. Fewer words do not eliminate movement, interaction, or waiting through a deliberately authored sequence. The child-and-bird story still has emotional stakes. Check the ordinary controls and whether the amount of interaction matches what you want from a game tonight.

Try this first. Follow the first simple routine and observe how images communicate the relationship. Let the initial section show you its rhythm. If you want many decisions or extensive dialogue, use that preference to choose another page rather than forcing this one.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P182 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Bird Story

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Bird Needed No Coalition Badge

A Bird Story's largely wordless little journey made Remy decide to rehearse his entrance without the fanfare. He pointed toward the stage, placed a hand over his heart and bowed.

Kit thought he was asking for the bathroom. She pointed down the hall.

Velvet understood immediately and gave him a grand answering bow. The exchange became a silent duel of increasingly unnecessary dignity. Tank put down his sandwich to watch.

I tried joining with a gesture meaning beloved host. Shawna interpreted it as indigestion and offered me water.

Nia sketched two figures dancing on the back of a programme. Her handwriting could frighten an experienced printer, but the little drawing was clear. Rae took it and added a third figure carrying the coats.

'That me?' I asked. 'You wanted a role,' Rae said.

The game's small interactions did not need us to invent a complex mystery. Nor did the picture. I would carry the coats while the women danced.

Remy finally found the stage. Kit applauded him for locating it.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the compact story if its wordless approach and interactions appeal. The coat-carrier understands his illustrated assignment, and Remy's silent entrance no longer points toward the toilets.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/327410/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P183 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

OPUS: Rocket of Whispers

Edition considered: PC release

Gather and build toward a meaningful farewell in a world shaped by loss, with exploration and crafting supporting the emotional story.

What you do. Travel through locations, gather materials, craft what is needed and follow the characters working toward their shared purpose.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

Main catch. Gathering and travel add practical work, while plague, bereavement and grief make the story emotionally demanding despite its gentle appearance.

Why it might click. Rocket of Whispers connects exploring a ruined snowy world with building a rocket to honor the dead. Objects found along the way reveal history as well as supplying materials. The gathering has an emotional purpose shared by the surviving characters.

The full catch. Expect travel, searching, equipment crafting, and keeping track of needed supplies. Plague aftermath, loss, and saying goodbye are central. The store's single-player description is explicit; two protagonists do not imply two-player control. Check navigation and repeated collection demands.

Try this first. Explore an early area and bring back one useful material or discovered story. Notice whether the search feels purposeful or repetitive. A strong emotional premise need not compensate for a gathering loop you do not enjoy.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P183 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

OPUS: Rocket of Whispers

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Rocket Was for a Farewell, Not My Press Kit

Rocket of Whispers brought its work of gathering toward a farewell into the room. Mercedes wanted the song heard without another announcement over the opening.

I lifted my hand toward the microphone, caught Shawna's expression and used the motion to adjust my collar. Nigga, a smooth recovery known to absolutely nobody.

Rosa remembered someone who would have loved the song. She told Tank one small story about them. He asked for another, and she chose to give it.

Across the table, Rae straightened the place cards. Nia helped without making the work into an excuse to ask a difficult question.

I had ordered a tiny decorative rocket for the centrepiece. Mika found it beside a box labelled AIDEN ASCENDS and turned the label toward the wall.

The game's loss belonged to its story. The room's memories belonged to whoever wanted to share them. Mercedes finished, and nobody rushed to fill the pause.

Then Rosa asked whether the tea was still hot. I checked before answering.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the farewell journey when its grief and practical gathering both feel welcome. Our centrepiece has surrendered its publicity campaign so the song can belong to the people hearing it.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/742250/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P184 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

OPUS: Echo of Starsong - Full Bloom Edition

Edition considered: PC Full Bloom Edition

Travel through an emotional science-fiction story where mysterious songs, remembered relationships and exploration give the journey its distinctive sense of longing and discovery.

What you do. Read conversations, explore locations, manage journey resources and work through light puzzles connected to the characters' search.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The voiced edition uses Japanese or Chinese audio with English text; resource choices and reading still need attention.

Why it might click. Full Bloom presents a voiced, visual-novel-style space adventure following Jun and Eda in search of mysterious starsongs. Their journey connects personal motives with conflict, ancient places, and other travelers. Music and the relationship between the leads are central attractions.

The full catch. The official page describes light puzzles and resource management alongside narrative scenes. English subtitles/interface are listed, while the checked full-audio languages are Japanese and Chinese. Check reading, exploration, and sound-puzzle presentation; the word accessible in marketing is not a complete control audit.

Try this first. Follow an early exchange, then inspect one exploration or travel decision. Confirm language settings and whether the sound-related information is presented in a usable way. Continue if the relationship interests you as much as the scenery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P184 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

OPUS: Echo of Starsong - Full Bloom Edition

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Starsong Was in the Wrong Key for Me

Echo of Starsong made Mercedes talk about a melody she remembered more clearly than the person who first played it. Porsche knew exactly which recording she meant.

I claimed an excellent ear. Mercedes played three notes. I named an expensive restaurant. 'That's where I heard them,' I said.

Kit called it a promising start for a menu.

The voiced game still carried English text for us to read. Nia adjusted her chair to see it. Rae moved her own rather than narrating over Nia's shoulder.

Remy wanted a piece of the music for his entrance. Velvet reminded him that wanting something beautiful did not put it in their show. He settled for asking Mercedes to help with his own tune.

I tried humming along. Shawna laid one finger against my lips, smiling. That was the most persuasive musical direction I received all night.

The strange journey kept its songs. Our room found a quieter harmony: Rae and Nia reading together, Porsche listening, and me temporarily absent from the soundtrack.

Aiden's verdict. Travel with the songs if the reading and resource choices suit. My excellent ear remains available, provided nobody mistakes it for permission to add my voice.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually opened Steam app1504500 and verified exact Full Bloom Edition title, voice-language table, narrative/exploration/light puzzle/resource description. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1504500/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P185 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

I Was a Teenage Exocolonist

Edition considered: PC release

Shape a life in a science-fiction colony, where relationships, remembered experiences and card-based decisions develop across years with consequences for the surrounding community.

What you do. Choose activities, build relationships, use experience cards and make decisions as the character grows within the colony.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Cards, skills, schedules and branching relationships require heavy tracking; the attractive setting also includes danger, death and difficult personal material.

Why it might click. This narrative roleplaying game follows ten formative years in an alien colony. Experiences become cards used in challenges, while activities and relationships influence the future. Its appeal is watching personal growth and a larger community's fate affect one another.

The full catch. Cards, skills, schedules, and branching relationships create substantial system and memory demands. The attractive watercolor setting includes danger, death, and difficult personal material. Inspect challenge rules and content information rather than treating a youthful cast as proof of lightness.

Try this first. Choose an early activity and learn one card challenge deliberately. Pay attention to a character whose company you enjoy. Decide whether the cards make your history feel meaningful or add a management layer you would prefer to avoid.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P185 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

I Was a Teenage Exocolonist

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Colony Rejected My Ten-Year Plan

I Was a Teenage Exocolonist made me wonder what our summit might become over ten years. I pictured recurring galas, an annual portrait and a building with my name above the lifts. Mika pictured a useful storage cupboard. Rae pictured replacing the workshop kettle. Nia pictured knowing Rae well enough to stop asking how strong she liked her coffee. 'That last one has a shorter procurement route,' Velvet said. The game's years, relationships and cards promised more to track than one attractive beginning. I was proposing a decade before we had agreed what happened after dessert. Kit asked which year included returning her glasses. They were on my programme. Again. I handed them over and abandoned the educational institute bearing my initials. Rae asked Nia to visit the workshop next week. Nia accepted and wrote the day clearly for once. I suggested making it an official summit follow-up. Shawna pulled my chair closer. 'Baby, you can have a future without chairing everybody else's.'

Aiden's verdict. Try the colony life if its branching systems and difficult material interest you. The summit has declined my decade of portraits while two people have successfully arranged next Thursday.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1148760/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P186 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Growing Up

Edition considered: PC release

Guide a life through interests, skills and school choices, with a nostalgic setting and everyday decisions gradually opening different possible futures for the character.

What you do. Choose activities, develop abilities, manage opportunities and take part in school-related tasks and minigames as time passes.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Numerous skills, planning decisions, exams and minigames can turn the life story into a substantial menu and tracking task.

Why it might click. Growing Up combines a coming-of-age story with choosing activities and developing skills. Friendships and family continuity give the schedules a narrative context, while its nineties setting offers a particular flavor of ordinary life and remembered ambitions.

The full catch. The primary description explicitly includes aptitude mini-games, exams, daily scheduling, many skills, and varied outcomes. This is a management-rich life game, not only dialogue. Check the mini-game inputs and whether balancing the systems feels enjoyable rather than like another planner.

Try this first. Set one early schedule, try its associated activity, and see how a friendship develops around it. Use the result to judge the management loop. There is no need to optimize a whole childhood before deciding whether you like playing one day.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P186 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Growing Up

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Life Coach Failed Lunch

Growing Up's everyday choices prompted me to describe the summit as an educational opportunity. Remy asked what we had learned. Tank said decorative chairs rarely improved a man's back.

I proposed a timetable for personal growth. Rae looked at it and found no lunch. 'Nigga, your future is hungry.'

Kit had once spent a whole summer learning a difficult song to impress somebody. She admitted she no longer remembered the person's name. She still knew the song.

Nia asked to hear it. Kit said she would, after her actual place in the programme. A personal achievement with excellent boundaries around its encore.

The game could make interests and skills accumulate across a life. Our evening did not need every conversation turned into a qualification.

Mika used the back of my timetable to draw the remaining stage positions. Velvet approved the space around her skirt.

Shawna asked what I wanted to learn next. I said how to make her stay beside me. 'Start by ordering lunch,' she replied.

Aiden's verdict. Explore the life choices if planning, exams and menus sound enjoyable. My personal-growth timetable now includes lunch and no longer awards a certificate for sitting beside my wife.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1191120/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P187 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Volcano Princess

Edition considered: PC release

Guide a young character's development through activities and relationships in a fantasy setting, seeing how many choices shape the life ahead of her.

What you do. Choose activities, develop skills, manage relationships and consider how different opportunities fit the character's growing interests and future.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Menus, statistics and many activities require planning; parental death and conflict accompany the development story, so inspect each activity's controls.

Why it might click. Volcano Princess mixes a fantasy coming-of-age story with arranging a daughter's activities, studies, and relationships. Different interests can lead toward different lives. The attraction is seeing a character develop through the choices and people around her.

The full catch. Menus, stats, planning, and multiple activity types are a substantial part of play. The story begins after a parent's death and includes conflict and combat-related training. Inspect each activity's controls and avoid treating the parenting premise as a simple conversation game.

Try this first. Choose one early activity and see how its result connects to a conversation or new opportunity. Check the calendar and character information together. Continue if guiding development is enjoyable without needing a supposedly perfect outcome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P187 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Volcano Princess

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Princess Had Not Applied to My Academy

Volcano Princess's development choices made me announce that I could recognise potential. Velvet asked whether that explained the gold chair whose upholstery had surrendered before the opening. I said I meant people. 'Then let them finish introducing themselves,' Rae replied.

Remy wanted to learn a quieter way to enter a room. Kit offered to coach him. He took one dignified step, whispered his stage name and made himself laugh.

Nia applauded. Rae asked whether the whisper came with a smaller invoice. Velvet defended his fee while requesting that he keep the ridiculous whisper in the show.

The game's young character belonged to its own story of guidance and consequences. The adults around me were perfectly capable of choosing which new thing to try.

I offered a scholarship anyway. Shawna handed me the replacement upholstery quote. 'Fund that first.'

Remy made a second entrance. The whisper landed beautifully. I paid for the chair and received no credit for developing his talent.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the development story if its many activities and heavier themes suit. Remy's new entrance belongs to Remy; my educational foundation currently repairs one gold chair.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1669980/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P188 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

Long Live The Queen

Edition considered: PC release

Plan a young ruler's education while dangerous events test what she has learned, making preparation and consequences the central attraction of the story.

What you do. Select lessons and activities, develop abilities and make story decisions whose outcomes depend on the skills already learned.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. This is a difficult planning detour with dangerous outcomes and death; substantial skill tracking matters more than the gentle-looking artwork.

Why it might click. Long Live The Queen makes preparation and choices the center of a perilous royal coming-of-age story. Learning which skills and decisions help the young heir survive can become a puzzle across attempts. It is an option for someone who actively enjoys that kind of consequence.

The full catch. The official premise emphasizes threats and survival. Skill planning, hidden consequences, and character death make this a deliberate detour rather than a low-pressure suggestion. Cute presentation does not soften the underlying challenge into a guaranteed easy evening.

Try this first. Inspect the training choices and follow an early consequence. Ask whether discovering how the system works is enjoyable even when an outcome goes badly. If avoiding punishing decisions is a hard preference, choose another story immediately.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P188 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Long Live The Queen

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Long Live the Woman Who Found the Switch

Long Live The Queen made Velvet declare that a crown required preparation. She opened her costume case, checked three fastenings and asked Remy to stand clear of the feathers.

I said natural majesty needed no rehearsal. At that moment my ceremonial sash slid off one shoulder and took a bread roll with it.

Kit caught the roll. Rae caught the sash. Nobody attempted to catch my authority.

The young ruler's dangerous education on screen carried consequences beyond its gentle appearance. Our own royal programme carried a simpler danger: I had ordered the spotlight to follow whichever crown was tallest.

Velvet's crown won. So did her performance, which had been rehearsed. I remained beside the darkened table holding a sash with butter on it.

Nia found the ordinary lamp switch so Rae could read the final wording. No palace intrigue required. Shawna pinned my sash properly. 'There,' she said. 'You may survive the remainder of dinner.' Nigga, I accepted the favourable prediction.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the ruler's difficult planning only if its danger and tracking appeal. The summit crown rewards rehearsal, while my continued reign depends on a pin and ordinary table lighting.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/251990/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P189 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Roadwarden

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a text-led journey through a difficult region, choosing routes and responses while supplies, time and encounters give the travel meaningful consequences.

What you do. Read locations and conversations, choose actions, manage supplies and decide which paths or duties to pursue on the journey.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Heavy reading, survival resources, health and limited in-game time add pressure; exact input timing remains unverified.

Why it might click. Roadwarden offers a richly written fantasy journey through settlements, roads, and uncertain loyalties. Its text-based roleplaying combines conversation, inventory problems, survival, and discoveries about a particular place. The pleasure is becoming familiar with a world through attentive decisions.

The full catch. The source explicitly mentions hit points, survival mechanics, and quests restricted by in-game time. Reading at your own pace does not remove that strategic pressure. Expect substantial text and several tracked resources; inspect any typed-response or menu operations.

Try this first. Reach an early conversation or travel choice and identify what it costs in the game's systems. Make one decision because you are curious about its result. Judge whether the prose and the management work well together for you.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P189 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Roadwarden

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Roadwarden Carried the Wrong Briefcase

Roadwarden's consequential journey made Rae ask what we actually needed for the walk to the signing table. Nia named the agreed draft. Kit named her glasses. Velvet named space for the dress. I arrived with a briefcase containing a speech, a spare speech and a photograph of me looking available for questions.

Rosa opened it, found no water and shut it again. 'You've packed a drought.'

The text-led traveller had supplies and limited time to consider. We had a room full of people whose patience could not be restocked by saying almost ready.

Mika checked the route. Remy moved his microphone stand. Dre lifted the casserole out of the only clear place for the document and put it where Tank could protect it.

Rae slipped the draft into my empty briefcase. 'There. Now you're useful luggage.'

I carried it carefully. Shawna walked beside me, one hand on my arm. Nigga, the journey improved as soon as the cargo stopped being my autobiography.

Aiden's verdict. Take the text-led road if survival resources, reading and limited in-game time sound engaging. My briefcase now transports the agreement instead of three versions of my importance.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1155970/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P190 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

The Life and Suffering of Sir Brante

Edition considered: PC release

Follow a life shaped by a rigid social order, with consequential choices about identity, loyalty and ambition giving the narrative its serious weight.

What you do. Read the character's developing life, choose responses and commitments, and follow how decisions alter relationships and possible futures.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense reading and long-term planning accompany oppression, death and costly consequences; this is a deliberately heavy narrative option.

Why it might click. This narrative roleplaying game follows a life within a harsh fantasy empire. Decisions, learned traits, family ties, and social position shape possible paths. It offers the pleasure of tracing how personal ambitions interact with an unjust and powerful order.

The full catch. The publisher calls it a hardcore narrative RPG and emphasizes costly consequences, oppression, death, and rebirth. Dense reading and long-term planning are central burdens. Treat it as a deliberate heavy-story option, not a gentle alternative simply because much of the action is written.

Try this first. Read an early chapter and inspect how one decision changes a relationship or trait. Decide whether you want to inhabit this society's pressures. You can value the writing without accepting the emotional weight of a full life inside it.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P190 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

The Life and Suffering of Sir Brante

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Sir Aiden's Suffering Was Mostly Upholstery

The Life and Suffering of Sir Brante made me consider how social order shaped a person. I started with the injustice of discovering my reserved chair had been moved.

Tank pointed across the room. 'It's by the socket.' 'I had a place of honour.' 'Now your phone has a place to charge.'

Nia wanted to hear the game's choices without me converting every serious premise into an allegory about my seating. Rae wanted to ask her about a difficult decision she had once made.

Nia answered. Not with a lesson for the room. With a story about leaving a job she had worked very hard to get.

Rae listened, then said she was glad the decision had brought Nia here. Nia smiled slowly.

The fictional hierarchy remained cruel. Our room did not need one. Kit took the chair nearest the lamp; Velvet took the space her costume required.

I sat beside Shawna. My suffering ended at a perfectly reasonable cushion.

Aiden's verdict. Consider this heavy life story for its consequential choices and dense reading. Sir Aiden has survived relocation to an ordinary cushion without requiring anyone else's place in the room.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected Steam primary description/category declarations for PC release. Premise and explicit features are supported; practical workload and routing are editorial judgments. No full-path input verification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1272160/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P191 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Suzerain

Edition considered: PC base game; Kingdom of Rizia expansion separate

Lead a fictional country through political choices, competing interests and personal relationships, with reports and conversations revealing the consequences of your decisions over time.

What you do. Read briefings, speak with political figures, choose policies and manage relationships that affect the country and the president's family.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense reading, many factions and difficult consequences create heavy tracking; the base-game card excludes the separate Rizia expansion.

Why it might click. As President Anton Rayne, you navigate Sordland's political institutions, economy, international relationships and family life. The attraction is sustained argument: people want incompatible things, and a policy decision can become a personal problem later.

The full catch. This is a dense reading and decision game with a codex, reports and many relationships to remember. Political violence and harsh outcomes add pressure. The inspected description does not establish every input's timing or hold requirements. This card covers the base game, excluding the Rizia expansion.

Try this first. Read the opening political setup and one conversation. Judge whether identifying factions feels intriguing or like an unwanted meeting. A companion can discuss priorities without supplying the supposedly correct ideology.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P191 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Suzerain

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The President Lost the Dessert Vote

Suzerain's competing interests turned the final dessert decision into a summit election. I nominated chocolate because a statesman should stand for something.

Rosa nominated fruit because we had already eaten three courses. Tank supported both positions with remarkable ideological flexibility.

Nia wanted a choice. Rae wanted whoever chose cheesecake to admit the hotel version was mediocre. Velvet demanded that dessert arrive before her lipstick had to be repaired again.

I proposed a grand coalition platter. Mika approved the spectacle, then discovered I had ordered it on a slab of ice with my initials carved through the middle.

The waiter asked where the meltwater should go. Nobody voted for the final draft.

The game's reports and factions could keep their complicated consequences. Our platter moved to the bar, where its initials gradually dissolved into a bucket.

Shawna fed me a strawberry. 'Still leading?' she asked. 'From the centre.'

'Nigga, you're standing over the drain,' Tank said. I accepted the fruit and declined a second election.

Aiden's verdict. Try the political story if its reading and faction tracking interest you. Our dessert coalition offers a choice, and the president's initials are no longer threatening the agreement.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1207650/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P192 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Yes, Your Grace

Edition considered: PC first game

Hear a kingdom's petitioners while balancing scarce resources, family needs and dangerous alliances, giving each political choice an immediate human face and cost.

What you do. Listen to requests, allocate resources, speak with family members and consider alliances and preparations as the kingdom's problems develop.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Requests conflict and resources run out; strategic preparation and harsh family outcomes prevent the throne screen from guaranteeing carefree play.

Why it might click. King Eryk hears petitioners, manages scarce resources and tries to protect his family and kingdom. Small requests sit beside larger alliances and threats, giving decisions an immediate human face rather than reducing everything to an abstract national graph.

The full catch. Resources run out, requests conflict and family decisions can hurt. The presentation includes strategic preparation and dangerous events; a throne screen is not a promise of carefree play. Verify the controls and pause behavior in the chosen PC version before assuming all situations wait.

Try this first. Hear the first petition and look at the resources attached to an answer. Ask whether saying no feels satisfyingly consequential or simply unpleasant. Stop without treating a difficult decision as something you must finish tonight.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P192 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Yes, Your Grace

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Your Grace Owes the Singer Money

Yes, Your Grace put petitioners before a ruler. Velvet immediately stood in front of my chair and requested the balance of her fee.

'A powerful dramatic parallel,' I said. 'A bank transfer,' she replied.

Remy wanted the spare microphone battery. Rosa wanted two people to move the hot tray. Shawna wanted me to stop referring to her perfectly ordinary request as the queen's business.

I spread my hands to suggest the burden of command. Rae put a tray in them. Nigga, the kingdom had identified an available resource.

Nia read the last practical clause to Mika while I carried dinner. They changed a clumsy phrase without asking whether history would remember the amendment.

The game's scarce resources and family stakes gave its petitions weight. Ours had weight too, especially the tray.

I paid Velvet before sitting down. She smiled and kissed my cheek, leaving a lipstick mark the exact size of my improved financial behaviour.

Shawna inspected it. 'Good. Now the invoice has a receipt.'

Aiden's verdict. Consider the petitioning kingdom if conflicting needs and harsh outcomes appeal. Our ruler has discovered that paying the performer resolves her request more effectively than describing his burden.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1115690/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P193 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Orwell: Keeping an Eye On You

Edition considered: PC first game

Investigate digital records for a surveillance programme, deciding which details to submit and discovering how your selections can change somebody else's life and apparent guilt.

What you do. Read messages, profiles and files, connect information, and choose which pieces of evidence to pass onward through the interface.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Dense records, names and relationships require tracking; evidence-transfer controls and any timing demands need a direct check.

Why it might click. You investigate digital records for a state surveillance program and decide what information to submit. The pleasure lies in connecting messages, profiles and apparent contradictions, then noticing how your selection shapes somebody else's fate.

The full catch. Expect substantial reading, interface switching and memory for names and relationships. Surveillance, terrorism and personal intrusion are central themes. Selecting or transferring evidence needs a direct input check; the premise alone cannot certify mouse-only ease, no dragging or an absence of timed sections.

Try this first. Examine one person's available records and identify two details that might mean different things together. Before forwarding evidence, decide whether the ethical discomfort interests you. A companion can compare interpretations while one person operates the interface.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P193 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Orwell: Keeping an Eye On You

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Surveillance System Found My Shopping Basket

Orwell's records made Mika joke that the summit needed a fact checker. I offered my phone as evidence of impeccable organisation.

Porsche glanced at the open shopping basket. It contained a rotating portrait stand, six ceremonial pens and a fountain shaped like a handshake.

'The fountain was research,' I said. Rae folded her arms. 'Into what? Wet sleeves?'

Nia wanted the final draft checked, not anybody's private messages. She slid that document across the table. Mika compared the actual wording with the practical arrangements already agreed.

Velvet caught a mistaken performance time. Remy caught his stage name spelled as King Recess. He briefly considered keeping it.

The game made selecting evidence consequential. Our little check worked because it concerned the thing we were about to use.

I closed the shopping basket without buying the fountain. Shawna looked delighted, which suggested a purchase cancellation could occasionally function as foreplay.

I did not ask to have that observation included in the minutes.

Aiden's verdict. Investigate the surveillance story if dense records and consequential selections appeal. The summit checked its draft, and my handshake fountain remains an unpurchased threat to dry clothing.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/491950/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P194 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Orwell: Ignorance is Strength

Edition considered: PC sequel

Investigate political information and manipulation in a darker surveillance story, where deciding what to investigate and when affects the narrative that emerges from the records.

What you do. Read digital records, compare accounts, choose investigative leads and consider how selected information shapes a political story.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The time-of-day system adds scheduling pressure; dense records remain, and actual real-time or pause behavior is not fully verified.

Why it might click. This second Orwell story places you in a darker investigation shaped by political narratives and information manipulation. It can reward a reader who enjoys noticing how an apparently factual detail becomes a persuasive weapon.

The full catch. The official description introduces a time-of-day system and decisions about whom to investigate and when. That establishes scheduling pressure inside the story, not a verified real-time countdown or a no-timer guarantee. Expect dense records, unsettling politics and morally compromised work.

Try this first. Read the first assignment and inspect how the interface represents time before making several moves. Decide whether tracking opportunities sounds engaging. Discuss one competing interpretation with a companion without assuming the game offers a neutral choice.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P194 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Orwell: Ignorance is Strength

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Headline Arrived Before the Agreement

Ignorance is Strength's information manipulation gave Porsche an idea for catching my latest excess. She found the announcement I had prepared: HISTORIC SUMMIT HAILS HOST.

'We haven't agreed the final sentence,' Nia said. 'The headline anticipates momentum,' I explained. Velvet took my phone and read the subheading. It claimed thunderous applause. Remy offered to generate some, but only after his fee cleared.

Rae suggested a more accurate headline: MAN ORDERS THINGS. Tank wanted a photograph of the receipt.

The game's time-of-day choices made the order of information matter. Our announcement had jumped over the part where people decided what they actually wanted to say.

Mika replaced it with the starting time and the room number. Both facts survived immediate scrutiny. Nia and Rae bent over the last line together. Their shoulders touched; neither moved away.

I asked Porsche whether we could retain historic. She said the hotel lift had broken twice, which gave me a better chance of being remembered as upstairs.

Aiden's verdict. Try the darker information story if its scheduling pressure and records interest you. Our announcement now reports a room and a time instead of predicting universal gratitude.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/633060/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

- | | | | | |
|----------------------|--------------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------------|
| Niggas, games up. | Niggas, pens out. | Niggas, chairs in. | Niggas, snacks here. | Niggas, receipts ready. |
| Niggas, lights on. | Niggas, mic check. | Niggas, take turns. | Niggas, dance later. | Niggas, read first. |
| Niggas, pick freely. | Niggas, no rush. | Niggas, sign here. | Niggas, stay petty. | Niggas, we're good. |

P195 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Emily is Away

Edition considered: PC first game

Follow a relationship through a nostalgic instant-messenger interface, where brief exchanges and changing profiles convey uncertainty, growing apart and things left unsaid across several years.

What you do. Read messages and profiles, choose responses, and use the messenger's keyboard interactions as conversations move through different stages.

Dialogue / text choices | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Test the actual typing demand and text size; relationship regret can weigh more heavily than the small interface suggests.

Why it might click. A simulated desktop and instant messenger frame a relationship across several years. Buddy profiles, changing circumstances and brief exchanges turn a familiar piece of technology into a story about growing apart, uncertainty and what people leave unsaid.

The full catch. Reading is central, and the messenger presentation includes keyboard interaction that should be tried directly. Do not assume every message is simply a pointer click or that arbitrary typing works identically across versions. Relationship regret may carry more weight than the small interface suggests.

Try this first. Choose a screen name and follow the first conversation far enough to feel its rhythm. Check the actual typing demand and text size. The useful question is whether the intimacy of messaging appeals, rather than whether you chose the best reply.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P195 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Emily is Away

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Nia Was Typing for an Unreasonable Amount of Time

Emily is Away's brief messages made Nia admit she had drafted Rae's dance invitation three different ways. Rae was sitting beside her when she confessed this.

'You could have asked,' Rae said. 'I did. Eventually.' 'You sent a paragraph.'

Nia showed her the unsent version. Rae read two lines and started laughing. It contained the phrase subject to mutual scheduling, which no slow dance had previously required.

I offered help. Shawna held out my own last message to her: AWAIT DEVELOPMENTS. Beneath it sat her reply: Bring the room key.

Velvet said men should not be allowed to abbreviate romance until they could locate a door.

The game's relationship could carry things left unsaid. Ours had briefly suffered from too many words said in advance.

Rae took Nia's hand. 'After the signing. One song. Then we'll see.' Nia stopped typing.

I sent Shawna a new message from six inches away. Got the key. She read it, smiled and pocketed my phone.

Aiden's verdict. Follow the messenger relationship if its text and regret feel inviting. Nia's invitation has become one spoken sentence, while my own romantic correspondence has finally located the key.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/417860/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
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P196 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

We Know the Devil

Edition considered: PC release

Three teenagers at a religious camp face an unsettling story about closeness, exclusion and belonging, with relationships carrying the tension of the visual novel.

What you do. Read the characters' exchanges and make choices about their time together, following how closeness shifts among the three.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Psychological horror, religious pressure and isolation are central; quiet-looking controls do not make the subject gentle or certify all inputs.

Why it might click. This visual novel uses a small cast and a threatening camp setting to explore belonging, exclusion and queer identity. Which characters spend time together matters, creating room for conversation about relationships rather than inventory puzzles or navigation.

The full catch. Psychological horror, religious pressure, isolation and an alarming soundscape are integral to the experience. Light movement demands would not make the subject gentle. The inspected page supports its visual-novel form but does not independently verify every advance input or the absence of all timing demands.

Try this first. Read the opening exchange and listen to a short portion of the atmosphere at a comfortable volume. Decide whether this kind of unease is welcome before pursuing a route. Nobody owes the camp a complete visit.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

Niggas, pens out.

Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P196 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

We Know the Devil

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Three Chairs and Nobody on the Outside

We Know the Devil's tension around closeness and exclusion made Kit look at the little seating cluster by the screen. Two chairs faced it properly. The third faced a plant.

'Who designed this?' she asked. I praised the intimacy before noticing where Remy was sitting. He raised one hand from behind the leaves. 'I'm having a very intense relationship with a fern.'

Velvet moved her chair sideways. Remy moved his forward. Kit adjusted the lamp, then asked whether everyone actually wanted this horror story tonight.

Rae did. Nia preferred to hear about it later. She went to help Rosa with dessert, taking no committee's disappointment with her.

The game's teenagers faced their own unsettling story. Our adult guests could simply want different things.

I started moving a fourth chair into the cluster for myself. Shawna tapped my shoulder. She had found a quiet table with two seats and no fern.

Nigga, I discovered a powerful commitment to leaving the arrangement alone.

Aiden's verdict. Choose the visual novel only if its psychological and religious horror feels welcome. Our third chair now faces the screen; choosing another seat does not require a defence.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Inspected primary product description supports the stated premise and features. Control-family, memory burden and recommendation are editorial assessments, not a complete accessibility audit. Timing or hold uncertainty is retained in the card. Exact PC edition only; source checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/435300/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P197 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

A Normal Lost Phone

Edition considered: PC release

Piece together a fictional person's life through messages, photographs and apps, discovering relationships and circumstances behind a disappearance by reading the details closely.

What you do. Navigate the fictional phone, read message threads, inspect pictures and connect information found across its different apps.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The recorded Steam page says unavailable; establish an existing playable copy, then check small text and navigation across apps.

Why it might click. Messages, pictures and apps form a narrative investigation into Sam's life and disappearance. The appeal is close reading: an ordinary digital object gradually reveals relationships and circumstances that were invisible at first glance.

The full catch. The inspected Steam page says this game is no longer available on that store as of September 20, 2026. Existing access must be established before planning a session. Expect personal, potentially sensitive material, small interface details and searching across apps; the page does not certify input comfort.

Try this first. If you already have a legitimate playable copy, inspect one message thread and test the fictional phone's navigation. Ask whether piecing together a person's circumstances feels compelling, and stop before curiosity becomes an obligation to finish.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.

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Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

Niggas, pick freely.

Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P197 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

A Normal Lost Phone

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Lost Phone Was Under My Own Elbow

A Normal Lost Phone had us looking at a fictional life through messages and apps. Then I could not find my actual phone and accused the summit of creating an immersive experience.

Tank pointed at my elbow. I lifted it. There lay the entire mystery, slightly warm and open to a photograph of my portrait.

Rae said the first clue had been my inability to stop leaning on myself.

The recorded availability catch meant we still had to establish a playable copy of the game. Mika checked that practical question while I attempted to restore the dignity of the real investigation.

Nia's phone chimed. Rae glanced at her face rather than the screen. Nia grinned and said the restaurant had confirmed their table.

I asked whether the summit would be mentioned during dinner. 'Only if the bill is surprising,' Rae said.

Shawna took my photograph again, this time without the portrait. She sent it to me. A private little improvement, delivered through a device I had successfully recovered.

Aiden's verdict. Consider the phone mystery only after establishing a playable copy and comfortable text. My actual missing device has been recovered from beneath the detective's very available elbow.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified Steam app 523210 identifies A Normal Lost Phone and explicitly states it is no longer available on Steam, observed September 20, 2026. Premise comes from the product description. Existing access, controls and availability elsewhere are not established.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/523210/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

P198 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Another Lost Phone: Laura's Story

Edition considered: PC release

Reconstruct Laura's life through her fictional phone, connecting personal and professional details to understand the circumstances behind her disappearance rather than exploring a physical landscape.

What you do. Read messages, examine photographs and navigate apps, separating what the phone shows from what you infer about its owner.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Close reading and app navigation are central; difficult personal circumstances and unverified control details remain meaningful catches.

Why it might click. A fictional found phone holds Laura's photographs, messages and apps. Following connections between professional life, relationships and social habits creates a story through investigation rather than through moving an avatar around a large landscape.

The full catch. Expect close reading, app navigation, inference and difficult personal circumstances. The official game site verifies the premise, while a retailer verifies this PC edition; neither settles every control demand or current availability elsewhere. Automated Steam matches were wrong, so those unrelated products are excluded from this card.

Try this first. Start by examining the fictional phone layout and a short exchange. Compare an observation with an interpretation, keeping them separate. Decide whether the interface is legible and the personal investigation welcome before following every available thread.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

Niggas, read first.

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Niggas, no rush.

Niggas, sign here.

Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P198 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Another Lost Phone: Laura's Story

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / Laura's Story Did Not Need My Press Release

Laura's Story had us connecting a fictional person's personal and professional details. I suggested an official summit biography for each guest.

Velvet asked whether mine mentioned the unpaid flower deposit. I said we would emphasise achievements. 'Then put paid flower deposit in your future ambitions,' she replied.

Rae said her biography could consist of mechanic, likes good snacks. Nia added terrible at leaving a café when she has somewhere to be.

Rae looked at her. 'You've known me one evening.' 'And we've left the coffee table four times.'

The game invited close reading of a particular life. Our biographies kept collapsing under the charming inconvenience that people could speak for themselves.

Remy wanted his to include an enthusiastic review from Kit. Kit offered: unusually committed to a pun. He accepted it with pride.

I tore up the proposed glossy booklet before it became another printing charge. Shawna asked me to keep one blank page.

She wrote our room number on it. At last, a biography with somewhere useful to go.

Aiden's verdict. Explore Laura's fictional records if close reading and difficult circumstances suit. The summit's glossy biographies have been replaced by people talking and one exceptionally useful room number.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Official game site anotherlostphone.com is credited to Accidental Queens and directly describes the narrative investigation, phone apps, friendships, professional life and disappearance. GameHouse separately verifies the PC title. Incorrect automated Steam matches were excluded. Neither source certifies full-path timing or holds; checked September 20, 2026.

Source 1: <https://anotherlostphone.com/>

Source 2: <https://www.gamehouse.com/games/another-lost-phone-lauras-story>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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P199 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Slay the Princess - The Pristine Cut

Edition considered: PC Pristine Cut

Question a confident narrator through a branching psychological-horror story, where choices and beliefs reshape the princess, the situation and the meaning of what happens.

What you do. Listen to narration, read choices and decide what to believe or do as the story changes around those decisions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. Intense violence, gore and suicide themes are explicit; voice acting does not settle every timed or held-input question.

Why it might click. The Pristine Cut expands a fully voiced psychological-horror visual novel whose branching story turns on what you do, believe and question. Narration, performance and shifting interpretations are major attractions for somebody who enjoys arguing with a story's apparent authority.

The full catch. The developer explicitly warns of intense violence, gore, partial nudity, strong language and suicide themes. This is a substantial content catch, not a gentle princess tale. Full voice acting does not establish no timed or held inputs; check the exact interface before making that assumption.

Try this first. Read the content notice first. If the premise still appeals, hear the initial narration and inspect how dialogue advances. Choose whether to continue for its argument and atmosphere, without accepting the narrator's urgency as your own.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, chairs in.

Niggas, snacks here.

Niggas, receipts ready.

Niggas, lights on.

Niggas, mic check.

Niggas, take turns.

Niggas, dance later.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P199 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Slay the Princess - The Pristine Cut

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Narrator Had No Authority Over the Door

Slay the Princess made the confident narrator a subject of suspicion. I found this excessive until Shawna asked whether my promised private terrace actually existed.

'The hotel described an exclusive outdoor experience,' I said. 'Where?' 'Beyond that door.'

Rae opened it. A tiny service balcony contained two stacked chairs and a mop. Nia looked at me with professional interest.

'Exclusive,' Tank said. 'Nobody else wants it.'

Velvet took one chair, sat beside the open door and announced she would perform a tragic monologue about misleading adjectives. Remy supplied a mournful chord from his phone.

The game's psychological horror could reshape what a claim meant. My claim needed only an ordinary door to become considerably less impressive.

Shawna pulled me toward the real window overlooking the city. 'This is enough,' she said.

I agreed before narrating anything else. Behind us, Velvet's princess demanded a better balcony and received a standing ovation from the mop.

Aiden's verdict. Try the branching horror only if its explicit disturbing themes appeal. The host's narration remains fallible, and the actual window offers a better view than his exclusive terrace.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually verified exact Steam title Slay the Princess - The Pristine Cut, app 1989270. Publisher description supports branching fully voiced psychological horror and expanded Pristine Cut; developer mature-content notice supplies the explicit content catches. No full-playthrough timing or hold audit.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1989270/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, mic check.

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P200 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

Scarlet Hollow

Edition considered: PC episodic release; current completion status must be checked

Enter a branching horror mystery where character traits, family relationships and a troubled town shape what you notice and how people respond to you.

What you do. Choose traits, read conversations, investigate unsettling events and make decisions that affect relationships and the story's branches.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Co-op details need checking

Main catch. The recorded release is unfinished; disturbing imagery remains despite the no-jumpscare statement and declared play without timed input.

Why it might click. Character traits and choices shape a branching horror mystery around a family visit and a troubled town. Conversations can reveal different details, making personality and relationships part of the investigation rather than merely decoration around clues.

The full catch. The inspected description lists five available episodes and another major update before the conclusion as of September 20, 2026: this is unfinished. The developer declares no jumpscare and Steam lists play without timed input, but disturbing imagery and tension remain. Neither statement certifies every hold or device.

Try this first. Inspect the opening traits and read the first family exchange. Decide whether you want a tense serial whose ending is still pending. A companion can debate impressions while the person playing keeps authority over the actual choices.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

P200 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

Scarlet Hollow

AIDEN AT THE SUMMIT / The Town Had Secrets; Our Draft Had My Thumbprint

Scarlet Hollow's troubled town and branching relationships made Rae ask whether the summit would look different through each guest's account. I said mine would be definitive.

Nia placed the final wording in front of me. There was a greasy thumbprint over the word voluntary. 'That's an editorial mark,' I said. 'That's a samosa,' Rosa replied.

Kit read the clean copy. Velvet checked her show time. Remy checked that his name still contained Receipts. Everybody found the part they needed without pretending to have written the whole evening.

The game's unfinished release remained an unfinished release; nobody in our room could promise its ending. We could finish this particular draft.

Nia asked whether Rae wanted any change. Rae said the signing table was level and the snack clause was understandable. 'The dance invitation stands?' Nia asked. 'It does.'

I lifted my clean hands away from the paper. Shawna smiled. Final wording agreed, portrait reimbursement still absent, and two women waiting for the song after the signatures.

Aiden's verdict. Visit the branching town if an unfinished horror story appeals. Our own wording is finished, my thumbprint is excluded, and the promised dance still belongs to its two participants.

Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Matched Steam publisher description on September 20, 2026 says five episodes available and another major update before the conclusion. Developer states no jumpscare; the Steam category declares playable without timed input. Those are sourced declarations, not a complete no-hold or no-distress certification.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1609230/>

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
Niggas, lights on.	Niggas, mic check.	Niggas, take turns.	Niggas, dance later.	Niggas, read first.
Niggas, pick freely.	Niggas, no rush.	Niggas, sign here.	Niggas, stay petty.	Niggas, we're good.

The Final Wording Left My Face Out of It

Nia read the finished wording once, slowly enough for everybody to follow. No heroic music beneath it. Remy had offered, but even he agreed that a fanfare could make a sentence about borrowing coats sound like a siege.

People could choose a game, ask for help, watch, take a break or decline. Sharing a controller required an actual agreement about who did what. The jukebox belonged to everyone's choices. Borrowing the old jacket began with asking the person who currently had it.

My portrait appeared nowhere.

I cleared my throat.

Shawna looked at me. 'You signed that order yourself.'

'I haven't raised the matter.'

'You raised your reimbursement throat.'

Rae laughed. Nia waited until the room settled, then asked whether the wording described what we had actually agreed.

June wanted it clear that she could still say Dez remembered the weather wrong. Dez wanted it clear that she could still point out the jacket's excellent lining.

'You can both keep telling your stories,' Nia said. 'This settles tonight's arrangements.'

They approved. The old war did not need a winner to stop acquiring new invoices.

Velvet checked that her paid performance stayed paid regardless of whether everybody watched. Remy checked his cue. Kit asked for the lamp to remain where she could read the song list. Mika checked the clock and looked briefly overcome by the astonishing possibility that the gala might begin.

Rosa brought the last tray past the table without catching her sleeve. Rae's repaired leg stayed steady. Tank sat beside her and declared the engineering department a success.

Nia put down the pen. Rae took her hand under the edge of the table. I saw their shoulders relax at the same time.

'Still after the signatures?' Rae asked.

'Still,' Nia said.

I wanted to tell them that a great romance deserved an audience. Then I remembered several great romantic moments in my own marriage had occurred specifically because the audience left.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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Niggas, mic check.

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Niggas, stay petty.

Niggas, we're good.

Shawna caught my eye. The woman could follow a terrible idea across my face before I found words expensive enough to decorate it.

'Good choice, baby,' she said.

'You don't know what I chose.'

'I know what you didn't say.'

The clean draft went into its folder. June and Dez rose slowly, helping each other without deciding which assistance counted toward the coat account. They would return for the signing after the last shared-play trial.

Mercedes touched the first chord of the chosen dance song. Rae looked toward the floor; Nia watched Rae.

Mika asked whether my portrait's lamp could stay off for the rest of the evening.

I looked at the faces already lit around the table.

'Yeah,' I said. 'Leave it.'

Nigga, the final wording was agreed. Nobody had surrendered a name, a story or the right to go home. I had surrendered one unnecessary spotlight, which felt like enough personal history for tonight.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

Niggas, games up.	Niggas, pens out.	Niggas, chairs in.	Niggas, snacks here.	Niggas, receipts ready.
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Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Second Great Butch vs. Stud War / Coalition Edition: new ChatGPT-generated comic prose and production, retaining the researched game cards and selection mechanics. This is a separate user-directed alternate companion; previous editions and source novels remain intact. All fictional participants are adults; Lillian remains the reader.

Revision base: the Tellings Cut at Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down commit 0e3fd666e7e1a0907e1e4dcd8ed3213cfee79a04. The earlier edition was grounded in sampled Niggatorial Tellings passages. The new summit cast, caucuses, romances and treaty are original companion fiction; they are not represented as recovered source canon. Editorial notes record the reading and rewriting scope.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This edition includes frequent non-hateful reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine references and consensual non-graphic sexual innuendo. The fictional crew chorus intentionally repeats the reclaimed plural fifteen times on each fixed PDF page, separate from game facts. EPUB pagination is reflowable; its chorus appears at chapter boundaries. Fiction does not describe developers, real readers or entire identity groups.

The First Great Butch vs. Stud War of 1967, the Blue Comet Social Club, its veterans and the present summit are fictional. They are not claims about actual LGBTQ history. The book uses overlapping personal identities and individual disagreements rather than treating butches, studs, lesbians, drag performers and trans people as mutually exclusive populations.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.

AIDEN AND TANK / THE COALITION CHORUS

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